

Literature dissection

Spring 2026

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Photo documentation

Individually:

1. Find the document titled “Data Description: Photo Documentation of the North Campus Open Space Restoration Project”.
2. Read about the photo documentation process.
3. Find 1-3 photo points relevant to your study using the ArcGIS web map.

As a group:

4. Discuss which photo point to focus on based on its relevance to your study question or context.
5. Decide on a photo point.
6. Find 2-4 photos at that photo point to represent seasonal changes within a water year.
7. In the table below, fill in the information for each photo at the photo point.

Table

Photo point number	Date of photo	Season	Direction of photo	Link to photo
42	April 2025	Spring	South	here
42	October 2024	Fall	South	here
42	April 2025	Spring	North East	here
42	October 2024	Fall	North East	here
42	April 2025	Spring	South East	here
42	October 2024	Fall	South East	here

8. Describe in 5-7 sentences total:
 - which water year you chose to examine
 - how that water year is relevant to your study
 - which photo point you chose to examine
 - how that photo point is relevant to your study
 - what changes you see in vegetation, animals, environmental characteristics from the photos you chose.

We chose to examine photos from water year 2025, which started on October 1st 2024 and ended on September 30th 2025. Our study is focused on how water elevation’s relationship to bird abundance, specifically in water year 2025, so photos from Fall 2024 and Spring 2025 are most relevant. We selected photo point 42, positioned on the Northern end of NCOS along the West Elings Marsh trail, because its photos capture a broad landscape of the slough’s profile, and water elevation is easily observable from that perspective.

Reports or posters

Individually:

1. Navigate to a. the Posters section or b. the Reports section of the collection.
2. Find the poster(s) or report(s) related to your project.

As a group:

3. Discuss which poster or report to focus on based on its relevance to your study question or context. **Note that you only need one of either type.**
4. Read the poster or report.
5. Discuss the key insights.
6. Provide the information in the space below. For “Key insights” and “Relevance to your study”, respond in 3-5 sentences.

Report or poster information

Title: Bird Community Analysis Report 1967–2015

Authors: Karen A. Stahlheber

Year published: 2015

Permalink: [here](#)

Dataset used (likely): Table 3.3 (Common and abundant species at selected sites in surveys from 1990 to 2014),

Key insights: Single-day and mean abundances of bird species across locations at NCOS from 1990-2014. The species with the highest mean abundances at each site are, for the most part, not within the taxon we are focusing on (shorebirds and waterfowl). However, the single-day abundance data provides us with some valuable metrics to compare our own data to, it provides abundance measurements for a variety of sandpiper species (shorebirds) and geese (waterfowl). Across all species, the waterfowl and shorebird taxons did not display the most abundant species at any location, but just comparing the two taxonomic groups, shorebird species were generally more abundant than waterfowl species.

Relevance to your study (be specific here with the question you have asked, the figures you’ve made, the insights you’ve gained, etc.): Our plots are visualizing bird species abundance within the waterfowl and shorebird taxonomic groups at NCOS, in relation to water elevation. We also have subplots that compare species abundance between shorebirds and waterfowl through time. This report provides relevant species abundance information at NCOS, which we can compare to our plots to identify changes and trends through time. It is important to acknowledge that this figure does not include abundance data for every species across every site and only includes data from 1990-2014.

Annotated bibliography

Background

You can find peer-reviewed articles by searching on Google Scholar, which is a large database of research papers, posters, and other materials.

Note: while it may be tempting to use AI to provide a list of papers for you, you should *not* be using AI for any component of this activity. You'll accomplish the objective of articulating the connection between your study and other study systems/questions by completing the difficult task of sifting through papers that may not be relevant to you before finding one that is.

Additionally, you can test out inserting citations in Quarto. See [this resource to insert a citation in a .qmd](#).

Directions

Individually:

1. Search Google Scholar for papers that might be relevant to your study. One recommendation for how to start: search for whatever your focal variables may be + “wetland restoration” (for example, “bird abundance wetland restoration”, “water salinity wetland restoration”, “aquatic invertebrate wetland restoration”).
2. Find 4-5 papers that might be relevant based on title and what shows up in the search.
3. Read the abstracts of those 4-5 papers.
4. Decide which - if any - are actually relevant to your project. Make a note of these papers. Note that a paper may be relevant in that it shares a) taxonomic groups, b) geographic regions, c) research questions, d) research methodology - there are lots of ways that existing research can be tied into your project.
5. If step 4 did not yield any relevant papers, repeat steps 2-4.
6. Search for papers until you have 4 relevant papers per person (12 total for a 3 person group).

As a group:

7. Share the papers you found, discussing the main points of the paper and how they are relevant to your project.
8. Fill in the template for an annotated bibliography below.
9. In the “Main findings” or “Relevance to study” sections, insert a citation for the paper.

Paper 1

Title: “Monitoring waterbird abundance in wetlands: The importance of controlling results for variation in water depth”

Authors: Bolduc, Afton

Main findings (2-4 sentences): In most non-diving waterbirds, abundance can be predicted through a non-linear relationship with wetland water elevation (Bolduc and Afton 2008). Abundance is low when water depth is 0, increasing as water height increases until a maximum is reached, then declining back to zero when depth becomes too deep to support foraging. After modeling abundance trends of two different hypothetical waterbird species (one generalist species and one specialist species) in four different hypothetical wetland habitats (differing in water height), the researchers found that relative corrected abundance of the generalist species varied greatly among wetland types, indicating water height has a significant impact on average abundance.

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences): Water elevation at NCOS is highly variable over the course of a given water year, meaning average Waterbird abundance is subject to change based on the hydrologic regime of Devereux Slough, according to the findings of Bolduc and Afton. The authors do mention, however, that Shorebirds are one group that diverges from the trends they plotted. Although they did not expand on this caveat, this was an important detail of their publication in relation to our study, as Shorebirds are one of two groups we’re choosing to investigate. We’ll need to keep this in mind moving forward.

Paper 2

Title: “Effects of Water Level Fluctuation on Waterbirds Distribution and Aquatic Vegetation Composition at Natural Wetland Reserve, Peninsular Malaysia”

Authors: Rajpar, Zakaria

Main findings (2-4 sentences): In this study conducted in Peninsular Malaysia, researchers found water level to be a major factor that influences the relative abundance and distribution of ducks (Rajpar and Zakaria 2011), along with many other families of bird that are not relevant to our study. Water elevation directly affects aquatic vegetation composition, which in turn determines the hunting and nesting patterns of waterbirds, therefore water level reflects the status/quality of habitat for waterbirds at a given time.

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences): Although this research was conducted in a distant region whose wetland species composition differs greatly from that of the Devereux Slough, these findings connect the dots between aquatic vegetation, water level, and waterbird abundance. This paper reminds us that we must consider *all* factors that play a role in determining bird abundance, including aquatic vegetation dynamics, when contextualizing our own findings, even though vegetation may not be included in our research questions.

Paper 3

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 4

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 5

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 6

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 7

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 8

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 9

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 10

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 12

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

References

- Bolduc, F., and A. D. Afton. 2008. [Monitoring waterbird abundance in wetlands: The importance of controlling results for variation in water depth.](#) Ecological Modelling 216:402–408.
- Rajpar, M. N., and M. Zakaria. 2011. [Effects of Water Level Fluctuation on Waterbirds Distribution and Aquatic Vegetation Composition at Natural Wetland Reserve, Peninsular Malaysia.](#) ISRN Ecology 2011:1–13.